

Emergency restrictions & martial law

ACTION CHECKLIST

If officials announce a curfew, movement restriction, state of emergency, or martial law, find the actual order from the authority that issued it. Check the affected area, start and end times, permitted travel, essential-service exceptions, and how updates will be announced. Keep identification and necessary medical information accessible, and seek qualified local legal help for a rights or detention question.

[] **Verify the announcement**

Read the original order or official alert rather than a repost. Confirm the issuing authority, jurisdiction, and effective time.

[] **Map the practical effect**

Note what movement or services are restricted, who is exempt, and where to obtain food, medication, medical care, and shelter.

[] **Plan essential movement**

Carry identification and relevant documentation, tell a contact your route, and use current official information about closures and checkpoints. Avoid unnecessary travel into a restricted area.

[] **Keep records and reassess**

Save the order, updates, and emergency contacts offline if possible. If you are detained or need advice about your rights, contact a qualified attorney or local legal aid.

WATCH FOR

Do not infer blanket rules from the phrase "martial law" in a headline. Follow live safety instructions, and verify any claim about suspended rights or universal powers against the actual order and local legal advice.

Updated 2026-10-02 | General guidance. Follow current local instructions. In immediate danger, contact emergency services.

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/emergency-restrictions/>

Constitution Annotated · Martial law generally

Ready.gov · Emergency alerts

U.S. State Department · Crisis response